sulkiness over the failure of the Anglo-Persian Agreement also helped ensure a change of direction in Foreign Office policies. Not that Curzon ever fully relinquished his ambitions in this region of the world (just as he could never bring himself to feel positive towards Bolshevik Russia). In May 1922, for example, he could not resist instructing Loraine to 'slowly Build Build Build' when he could.[180] But as stubborn as he was, Curzon had to admit by 1923 that pursuing a more limited role in Persia was actually working to Britain's advantage. It was just unfortunate for Britain that the foreign secretary had not been made to realise this sooner. For, as demonstrated, there was nothing in Loraine's Persian policy which the Indian government had not been advocating for years, and which it was already doing in Afghanistan – being as little involved in the country's internal affairs as was necessary to simply retain a British presence. The foreign secretary's peculiar inability to listen to the advice coming from Delhi had cost Britain valuable prestige points in the years after 1918. At least this was beginning to be rectified. Indeed, by 1923 Britain's relations in South Asia had settled down to something akin to the pre-war years, with London accepting both the limitations of the empire's capabilities and the inevitable presence of Russia in this region.